csv Data Manipulation

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The **csv Data Manipulation** GUI lets you reshape and clean csv files with point-and-click — no programming. In INPUT it takes one csv file (two or more for the APPEND and MERGE operations); in OUTPUT it writes a new csv file (or a txt file for the EXTRACT operation). You choose a single operation at a time from a dropdown menu, and only the widgets that operation needs become active.

1. Selecting the INPUT csv file(s)

Use the **Select INPUT CSV file** button to pick your csv file; it opens in the NLP output directory set in your configuration and pre-selects the most recent csv. The chosen file is added to the **file dropdown**, which you can use to roll through every file you have added and make any one of them the current file — its fields then load in the *Select field* menu below.

- The APPEND and MERGE operations require two or more files. Use the **+** file button (on the operation row) to add another csv file.
- Re-clicking **Select INPUT CSV file** starts a fresh list (you are warned first if you would lose an accumulated list).

2. Choosing an operation

Pick what to do from the **operation dropdown menu**. The widgets on the same row activate according to your choice: the *Select field* menu, the *Character separator* box, the *WHERE clause* button, the two **+** buttons (add another field / add another file), and the **OK** button.

Operation	In INPUT	In OUTPUT
APPEND rows	2+ csv files with the same fields	one csv stacking the rows of all files
CONCATENATE fields	1 csv, 2+ fields, a separator character	csv with a new field joining the values
SPLIT field	1 csv, 1 field, a separator character	csv with the field split into new columns
DROP rows	1 csv, a WHERE condition	csv with the matching rows removed
EXTRACT field(s)	1 csv, selected field(s), optional WHERE	csv or txt with only those fields
MERGE files	2+ csv files, overlapping key field(s)	one csv joined on the key (an SQL JOIN)
SORT rows	1 csv, sort field(s), ascending/descending	csv sorted by the chosen field(s)
DEDUPLICATE rows	1 csv, optionally a key field	csv with duplicate rows removed
RENAME field	1 csv, a field, a new name	csv with the column header renamed

SPLIT is the inverse of CONCATENATE — both use the *Character separator* box (one to join fields, the other to cut a field apart).

3. The WHERE clause (DROP and EXTRACT only)

The WHERE clause filters rows by field value. After selecting a field, click the **WHERE clause** button to activate the widgets, then:

- select a **comparator**: <> (not equal), =, >, >=, <, <= ;
- type the value to compare against in the **WHERE** box (**CASE SENSITIVE**);
- choose **and/or** to combine with a further condition, then press **+** to add it.

Example: EXTRACT only the rows where `Year >= 1997`; or DROP the rows where `Stopword = the`. Leave the WHERE clause empty to operate on all rows.

4. Approving selections and running

1. Press **OK** to approve your selections; they are recorded and shown in the read-only display box.
2. Check the display box, then press **RUN** to process the operation.
3. Press **Reset all** to clear everything — the operation, the fields, the WHERE clause, and the file list — and start fresh.

5. These operations, and their SQL equivalents

Every operation here has a Structured Query Language (SQL) equivalent. If you would rather query your data with SQL — filtering on several conditions at once, joining files, or counting/summing by group — open the **CSV data manipulation with SQL** GUI from the *GUIs available for more analyses* dropdown at the top of this GUI.

Data manipulation	SQL equivalent
EXTRACT field(s)	`SELECT field1, field2 FROM mytable`
EXTRACT with a WHERE filter	`SELECT * FROM mytable WHERE year = 1997`
DROP rows	`SELECT * FROM mytable WHERE NOT (stopword = 'the')`
SORT rows	`SELECT * FROM mytable ORDER BY author, year DESC`
Frequency / group counts	`SELECT author, COUNT(*) FROM mytable GROUP BY author`
MERGE files	`SELECT ... FROM a JOIN b ON a.key = b.key`

Note: the DB SQL GUI works on a **folder**, not a single file — it builds a small SQLite database from every csv/xlsx in the folder (one file becomes one table, the header row becomes the column names). See the TIPS *Using SQL on one or two csv files* for the full workflow.

6. When to leave this GUI

The Data manipulation GUI handles the everyday cleaning and reshaping operations. For heavier, analytical work, use the companion tools in the "GUIs available for more analyses" dropdown:

- **CSV data manipulation with SQL** — full SQL queries and joins on a folder of csv/xlsx files (DB SQL).
- **Statistics on csv files** — frequencies, GROUP-BY counts, cross-tabulations (contingency tables), and statistical tests.
- **CSV data visualization** — charts of your data in a variety of Plotly formats.

See also: TIPS — Using SQL on one or two csv files; TIPS — DB SQL GUI; TIPS — Statistical tools.